10% of energy goes into new body cells and will be available to the next animal when it gets eaten. This loss of energy at each trophic level can be shown by an **energy pyramid.**

A rat eats grains; and in turn we know snake eats rat. Now snake is a prey for peacock and in turn peacocks are easy prey for tigers and leopards. Now think? Do tigers have any natural predators?

In all food chain there is a top level predator that has no natural predators. In an aquatic ecosystem there are no natural predator for alligator; in a forest there are no natural predators for tigers.

Importance of food chain

1. Learning food chain help us to understand the feeding relationship and interaction between organisms in any ecosystem.

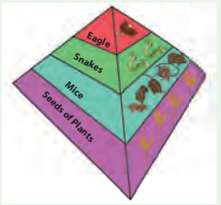
2. Understanding the food chain also helps us to appreciate the energy flow and nutrient circulation in an ecosystem. This is important because pollution impacts the ecosystem. The food chain can be used to understand the movement of toxic substances and their impacts.

Food web

Consumers have different sources of food in an ecosystem and do not rely on only one species for their food. If we put all the food chains within an ecosystem together, then we end up with many interconnected food chains. This is called a food web.

A food web is very useful to show different feeding relationships between different species within an ecosystem.

Activity 2: Take a square paper. Fold its diagonals. Draw three lines in three triangles as shown in the picture.

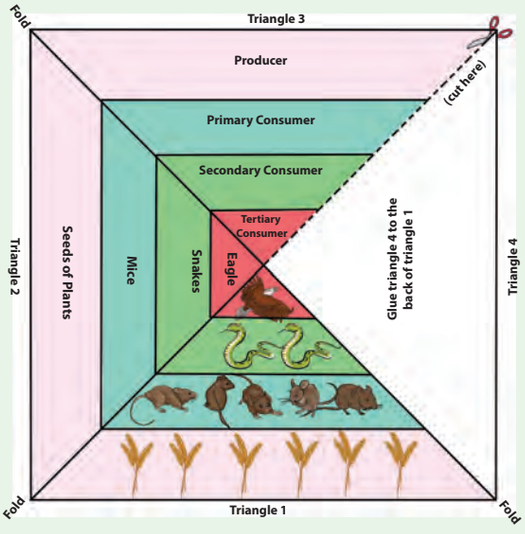


Cut from the edge of the diagonal to the center as shown in the picture.

If you fold this triangle and paste behind the third triangle you get a pyramidal shape.

In one of the triangles, draw images of each of the organisms in the different levels.

In another triangle write the names of the organisms. In the last triangle, write the energy level of the organism. Have a look at the following example. You must come up with different organisms!.



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